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Reading: Glossary terms from module 4

Terms and definitions from Course 5, Module 4

Angler phishing: A technique where attackers impersonate customer service representatives on social media

Advanced persistent threat (APT): Instances when a threat actor maintains unauthorized access to a system for an extended period of time

Adware: A type of legitimate software that is sometimes used to display digital advertisements in applications

Attack tree: A diagram that maps threats to assets

Baiting: A social engineering tactic that tempts people into compromising their security

Botnet: A collection of computers infected by malware that are under the control of a single threat actor, known as the “bot-herder"

Cross-site scripting (XSS): An injection attack that inserts code into a vulnerable website or web application

Cryptojacking: A form of malware that installs software to illegally mine cryptocurrencies

DOM-based XSS attack: An instance when malicious script exists in the webpage a browser loads

Dropper: A type of malware that comes packed with malicious code which is delivered and installed onto a target system

Fileless malware: Malware that does not need to be installed by the user because it uses legitimate programs that are already installed to infect a computer

Hacker: Any person or group who uses computers to gain unauthorized access to data

Identity and access management (IAM): A collection of processes and technologies that helps organizations manage digital identities in their environment

Injection attack: Malicious code inserted into a vulnerable application

Input validation: Programming that validates inputs from users and other programs

Intrusion detection system (IDS): An application that monitors system activity and alerts on possible intrusions

Loader: A type of malware that downloads strains of malicious code from an external source and installs them onto a target system

Malware: Software designed to harm devices or networks

Process of Attack Simulation and Threat Analysis (PASTA): A popular threat modeling framework that's used across many industries

Phishing: The use of digital communications to trick people into revealing sensitive data or deploying malicious software

Phishing kit: A collection of software tools needed to launch a phishing campaign

Prepared statement: A coding technique that executes SQL statements before passing them onto the database

Potentially unwanted application (PUA): A type of unwanted software that is bundled in with legitimate programs which might display ads, cause device slowdown, or install other software

Quid pro quo: A type of baiting used to trick someone into believing that they'll be rewarded in return for sharing access, information, or money

Ransomware: Type of malicious attack where attackers encrypt an organization's data and demand payment to restore access

Reflected XSS attack: An instance when malicious script is sent to a server and activated during the server's response

Rootkit: Malware that provides remote, administrative access to a computer

Scareware: Malware that employs tactics to frighten users into infecting their device

Smishing: The use of text messages to trick users to obtain sensitive information or to impersonate a known source

Social engineering: A manipulation technique that exploits human error to gain private information, access, or valuables

Spear phishing: A malicious email attack targeting a specific user or group of users, appearing to originate from a trusted source

Spyware: Malware that's used to gather and sell information without consent

SQL (Structured Query Language): A programming language used to create, interact with, and request information from a database

SQL injection: An attack that executes unexpected queries on a database

Stored XSS attack: An instance when malicious script is injected directly on the server

Tailgating: A social engineering tactic in which unauthorized people follow an authorized person into a restricted area

Threat: Any circumstance or event that can negatively impact assets

Threat actor: Any person or group who presents a security risk

Threat modeling: The process of identifying assets, their vulnerabilities, and how each is exposed to threats

Trojan horse: Malware that looks like a legitimate file or program

Vishing: The exploitation of electronic voice communication to obtain sensitive information or to impersonate a known source

Watering hole attack: A type of attack when a threat actor compromises a website frequently visited by a specific group of users

Whaling: A category of spear phishing attempts that are aimed at high-ranking executives in an organization

Web-based exploits: Malicious code or behavior that's used to take advantage of coding flaws in a web application

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